

HR TRAINING

MODULE 4**Employee Relations****STUDENT WORKBOOK***100 Practice Exercises — Written Response, Multiple Choice, and True/False*

A Traction Outsourcing Limited HR Training Resource

BUILT BY AFRICANS, FOR AFRICA

www.tolnigeria.com**OUR SERVICES**

Staff Outsourcing & HR Management · Startup Structuring · Corporate Restructuring · Business Advisory ·
Employee Training · Corporate Retreats & Events · Professional Trainings

partner@tolnigeria.com | 0805 203 3145 · 0812 507 8087 · 0707 870 7777

Module 4: Employee Relations — Workbook

A Traction Outsourcing Limited HR Training Resource

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook accompanies Module 4: Employee Relations and contains 100 exercises organized into three parts. Work through each part in order, or use individual exercises to review a specific section of the module. Exercises are grouped by type, and within each type they follow the same section order as the module.

Type A — Written Response (20 exercises, A1–A20)

Each item presents a question, statement, or workplace scenario drawn from the module. Write your answer in the ruled space provided, or on a separate sheet if you need more room. These exercises have no single correct wording — they are graded by your facilitator against the concepts covered in the module.

Type B — Multiple Choice (40 exercises, B1–B40)

Each item presents a question or scenario with four possible answers (A–D). Mark the box beside the one best answer. Check your work against the Multiple Choice Answer Key at the back of this workbook.

Type C — True/False (40 exercises, C1–C40)

Each item presents a statement drawn from the module. Mark whether the statement is True or False. Check your work against the True/False Answer Key at the back of this workbook.

Exercise Breakdown by Module Section

Module Section	Type A	Type B	Type C	Total
Employee Turnover	2	3	3	8
Employee Retention	2	3	3	8
Employee Survey	2	3	3	8
Employee Focus Group	1	2	2	5
Exit Interviews	1	3	3	7
Employee Relations Programs	1	2	2	5
Grievance Management	2	4	4	10
Alternative Dispute Resolution	1	2	2	5
Workforce Reduction	2	3	3	8
Progressive Discipline	2	3	3	8
Managing Workplace Behaviors	2	4	4	10
Termination	1	2	2	5
Outplacement	1	3	3	7
Employee Offboarding	0	3	3	6

Module Section	Type A	Type B	Type C	Total
Total	20	40	40	100

Part I — Written Response Exercises (A1–A20)

Read each scenario, statement, or question carefully and write your response in the space provided.

Employee Turnover

A1. Explain the difference between voluntary and involuntary turnover as defined in the module, and give one example of each.

Your response:

A2. Explain the difference between functional and dysfunctional turnover, per the module, and describe why not all turnover is negative for an organization.

Your response:

Employee Retention

A3. List three of the “myths and realities” about employee retention discussed in the module, and explain why understanding these matters for HR.

Your response:

A4. Describe two “drivers” of retention identified in the module (for example, rewards, career training and development, employer policies, or work relationships) and explain how an employer could take action on one of them.

Your response:

Employee Survey

A5. Explain the difference between job satisfaction, organizational commitment, and employee engagement, as defined in the module.

Your response:

A6. Describe the five steps of the employee survey cycle described in the module, and explain why action planning after a survey is important.

Your response:

Employee Focus Group

A7. Explain what an employee focus group is and describe two guidelines the module gives for how such groups should be run (for example, group size, choice of moderator, or timing).

Your response:

Exit Interviews

A8. Explain the purpose of an exit interview per the module, and describe why the module recommends against having an employee's direct supervisor conduct it.

Your response:

Employee Relations Programs

A9. Explain the difference between employee participation and employee involvement as described in the module, and describe why diversity and inclusion programs matter to positive employee relations.

Your response:

Grievance Management

A10. Explain the difference between a complaint and a grievance as defined in the module, and describe how responsibilities for handling grievances are typically divided between HR and line managers.

Your response:

A11. List the nine steps of the grievance investigation process described in the module, and explain why an employer should never promise complete confidentiality.

Your response:

Alternative Dispute Resolution

A12. Compare two of the four alternative dispute resolution techniques described in the module (open-door policy, peer review, mediation, arbitration), including how each one works.

Your response:

Workforce Reduction

A13. Explain the difference between redundancy and attrition as methods of downsizing, per the module.

Your response:

A14. List the four reasons for downsizing described in the module, and explain what employee rights protect at-will employees during a workforce reduction.

Your response:

Progressive Discipline

A15. List the four typical steps in a progressive discipline system described in the module, and explain the primary purpose of progressive discipline.

Your response:

A16. Explain what should be included in a written warning under progressive discipline, per the module, including its expiration date.

Your response:

Managing Workplace Behaviors

A17. Explain the difference between culpable and non-culpable behaviors as defined in the module, giving one example of each.

Your response:

A18. Explain the difference between bullying and harassment as described in the module.

Your response:

Termination

A19. List the four elements of a termination process described in the module (paper trail, short clear meeting, explaining severance, communicating with staff), and explain why building a paper trail matters before a termination.

Your response:

Outplacement

A20. Explain what outplacement is per the module, and describe two benefits it provides to the employer.

Your response:

Part II — Multiple Choice Exercises (B1–B40)

Mark the box beside the one best answer for each item.

Employee Turnover

B1. Per the module, when the organization initiates an employee's departure, this is called:

- ☐ **A)** Voluntary turnover
- ☐ **B)** Involuntary turnover
- ☐ **C)** Attrition
- ☐ **D)** Outplacement

B2. Per the module, the turnover rate is calculated as:

- ☐ **A)** (Number of employees leaving / average number of employees) x 100
- ☐ **B)** (Number of new hires / total employees) x 100
- ☐ **C)** (Total employees / number of employees leaving) x 100
- ☐ **D)** (Average tenure / total employees) x 100

B3. Per the module, functional turnover occurs when:

- ☐ **A)** Key individuals and high performers leave at critical times
- ☐ **B)** Lower-performing or disruptive employees leave
- ☐ **C)** The organization lays off an entire department
- ☐ **D)** An employee retires after 30 years of service

Employee Retention

B4. Per the module, which of the following is identified as a myth about employee retention?

- ☐ **A)** Hiring has little to do with retention
- ☐ **B)** Career training and development affects retention
- ☐ **C)** Work relationships affect retention
- ☐ **D)** Organizational factors affect retention

B5. Per the module, which of the following is listed as a “driver” of retention?

- ☐ **A)** Rewards: compensation, benefits, and performance
- ☐ **B)** Office furniture style
- ☐ **C)** Company logo design
- ☐ **D)** Parking lot size

B6. Per the module, a stay interview is best described as:

- ☐ **A)** An interview conducted after an employee has already resigned
- ☐ **B)** A retention tool used to identify why employees stay with the company
- ☐ **C)** A disciplinary meeting for poor performers
- ☐ **D)** A recruitment screening interview

Employee Survey

B7. Per the module, which term is defined as an individual's dedication and loyalty to an organization?

- ☐ **A)** Job satisfaction
- ☐ **B)** Organizational commitment
- ☐ **C)** Organizational climate
- ☐ **D)** Job involvement

B8. Per the module, the five steps of the employee survey cycle are preparation, communication, implementation, analysis, and:

- ☐ **A)** Termination
- ☐ **B)** Action planning
- ☐ **C)** Outplacement
- ☐ **D)** Recruitment

B9. Per the module, to protect anonymity in an employee survey, organizations should:

- ☐ **A)** Ask detailed questions about gender and years of service
- ☐ **B)** Allow colleagues to watch employees complete the questionnaire
- ☐ **C)** Keep questions about personal characteristics to a minimum
- ☐ **D)** Allow employees to complete the survey multiple times

Employee Focus Group

B10. Per the module, an employee focus group should ideally have no more than how many employees per group?

- ☐ **A)** 3-5
- ☐ **B)** 10-12
- ☐ **C)** 25-30
- ☐ **D)** 50

B11. Per the module, why might managers sometimes be excluded from their own team's focus group?

- ☐ **A)** So employees feel they can speak more freely
- ☐ **B)** Because managers are not allowed in the building
- ☐ **C)** Because managers do not understand the survey
- ☐ **D)** Because it saves money

Exit Interviews

B12. Per the module, exit interviews are best conducted by:

- ☐ **A)** The employee's direct supervisor
- ☐ **B)** A neutral person, such as HR or a consultant
- ☐ **C)** The employee's closest coworker
- ☐ **D)** No one; exit interviews are not recommended

B13. Per the module, when is it generally best to conduct an exit interview?

- ☐ **A)** Immediately upon hire
- ☐ **B)** Not until after the person leaves, or even a couple of weeks later
- ☐ **C)** During the employee's performance review
- ☐ **D)** Only if the employee requests it

B14. Per the module, the real purpose of an exit interview is to:

- ☐ **A)** Convince the employee to stay
- ☐ **B)** Find out the true catalyst that started the employee looking for a new opportunity
- ☐ **C)** Complete a legal formality with no further use
- ☐ **D)** Determine the employee's final paycheck amount

Employee Relations Programs

B15. Per the module, employee involvement is best described as:

- ☐ **A)** A team-based approach where a group shares responsibility for a goal
- ☐ **B)** A one-on-one approach between the employee and management
- ☐ **C)** A formal grievance procedure
- ☐ **D)** An exit interview technique

B16. Per the module, the purpose of diversity training is to:

- ☐ **A)** Increase awareness of individual differences and reduce the use of stereotypes
- ☐ **B)** Reduce the number of employee grievances
- ☐ **C)** Standardize employee dress codes
- ☐ **D)** Eliminate the need for performance reviews

Grievance Management

B17. Per the module, a grievance is best defined as:

- ☐ **A)** Any complaint, whether written or not
- ☐ **B)** A complaint that has been put in writing and made formal
- ☐ **C)** A performance review
- ☐ **D)** A verbal warning

B18. Per the module, which of the following is typically an HR department responsibility in grievance handling, rather than a manager's?

- ☐ **A)** Monitoring trends in grievance rates for the organization
- ☐ **B)** Attempting to resolve grievances "closest to the problem"
- ☐ **C)** Documenting grievance cases
- ☐ **D)** Engaging in grievance prevention efforts at the team level

B19. Per the module's nine-step grievance investigation process, which step comes first?

- ☐ **A)** Conduct interviews
- ☐ **B)** Ensure confidentiality
- ☐ **C)** Make a decision

- ☐ **D)** Develop written results

B20. Per the module, grievance arbitration has been criticized as:

- ☐ **A)** Too costly, too legalistic, and too time-consuming
- ☐ **B)** Too fast and inexpensive
- ☐ **C)** Never used by any organization
- ☐ **D)** Only applicable to non-union firms

Alternative Dispute Resolution

B21. Per the module, which ADR technique is described as the simplest, most direct, and least expensive way to settle a dispute?

- ☐ **A)** Arbitration
- ☐ **B)** Mediation
- ☐ **C)** Open-door policy
- ☐ **D)** Peer review

B22. Per the module, in mediation:

- ☐ **A)** The mediator's decision is binding on both parties
- ☐ **B)** A neutral outside party helps the parties reach a settlement, but cannot force a solution
- ☐ **C)** A panel of peers issues a binding verdict
- ☐ **D)** The dispute is automatically escalated to court

Workforce Reduction

B23. Per the module, workforce reduction is also known as:

- ☐ **A)** Onboarding
- ☐ **B)** Downsizing or reduction in force (RIF)
- ☐ **C)** Outplacement
- ☐ **D)** Progressive discipline

B24. Per the module, which downsizing method realizes savings by not filling vacancies when employees resign or retire?

- ☐ **A)** Redundancy
- ☐ **B)** Attrition
- ☐ **C)** Offshoring
- ☐ **D)** Mediation

B25. Per the module, moving a business process to a lower-cost labor country is known as:

- ☐ **A)** Attrition
- ☐ **B)** Redundancy
- ☐ **C)** Offshoring
- ☐ **D)** Outplacement

Progressive Discipline

B26. Per the module, the primary purpose of progressive discipline is to:

- ☐ **A)** Punish the employee
- ☐ **B)** Assist the employee to understand that a performance problem exists and needs correcting
- ☐ **C)** Immediately terminate underperforming employees
- ☐ **D)** Avoid documenting employee behavior

B27. Per the module, which is the first step in a typical progressive discipline system?

- ☐ **A)** Written warning
- ☐ **B)** Termination
- ☐ **C)** Informal verbal warning
- ☐ **D)** Formal verbal warning

B28. Per the module, a written warning under progressive discipline should include:

- ☐ **A)** No expiration date
- ☐ **B)** An expiration date, typically six months to one year
- ☐ **C)** Immediate termination
- ☐ **D)** No documentation

Managing Workplace Behaviors

B29. Per the module, “culpable” behaviors are those in which:

- ☐ **A)** The employee is not blameworthy
- ☐ **B)** The employee is in control and responsible for their actions
- ☐ **C)** The employer is at fault
- ☐ **D)** No disciplinary action is ever warranted

B30. Per the module, innocent absenteeism is absence:

- ☐ **A)** Due to a genuine cause or reason, such as illness
- ☐ **B)** Without any genuine reason
- ☐ **C)** That is always disciplined immediately
- ☐ **D)** That never requires documentation

B31. Per the module, what distinguishes harassment from bullying?

- ☐ **A)** Harassment is always physical, bullying is always verbal
- ☐ **B)** Harassment is based on a protected class (race, sex, religion, etc.), while bullying is not necessarily based on a protected class
- ☐ **C)** Bullying is illegal, harassment is not
- ☐ **D)** There is no distinction between the two

B32. Per the module, employers can best address suspected substance abuse by:

- ☐ **A)** Publicly confronting the employee in front of coworkers
- ☐ **B)** Framing the conversation around job performance issues in a private meeting
- ☐ **C)** Ignoring the issue entirely
- ☐ **D)** Immediately terminating the employee without any conversation

Termination

B33. Per the module, before terminating an employee, employers should build a:

- ☐ **A)** Marketing plan
- ☐ **B)** Paper trail documenting reasons for the dismissal
- ☐ **C)** New job description
- ☐ **D)** Employee engagement survey

B34. Per the module, when communicating a termination to remaining staff, employers should:

- ☐ **A)** Share all confidential details about the reason for termination
- ☐ **B)** Say a certain worker was terminated without going into details about the reason, and focus on future plans
- ☐ **C)** Avoid saying anything at all
- ☐ **D)** Ask remaining staff to vote on the decision

Outplacement

B35. Per the module, outplacement is best described as:

- ☐ **A)** A recruitment process for filling vacancies
- ☐ **B)** A systematic process of counseling a laid-off employee in career self-appraisal and securing a new job
- ☐ **C)** A type of employee benefit only offered to executives
- ☐ **D)** A disciplinary process

B36. Per the module, which of the following is listed as a benefit of outplacement to the employer?

- ☐ **A)** Enhances the morale of those who remain
- ☐ **B)** Increases the threat of litigation
- ☐ **C)** Reduces employee engagement
- ☐ **D)** Eliminates the need for severance pay

B37. Per the module, outplacement benefit packages typically vary in length between:

- ☐ **A)** One day and one week
- ☐ **B)** Three months and one year (or until a suitable job is accepted)
- ☐ **C)** Five and ten years
- ☐ **D)** There is no typical range

Employee Offboarding

B38. Per the module, which of the following is a step in the employee offboarding process?

- ☐ **A)** Obtain a resignation letter
- ☐ **B)** Require a handover process
- ☐ **C)** Obtain company property
- ☐ **D)** All of the above

B39. Per the module, a non-compete agreement typically restricts an employee from working for a competing firm for:

- ☐ **A)** One day to one week
- ☐ **B)** Six months to two years following employment ending
- ☐ **C)** The employee's entire lifetime
- ☐ **D)** No time at all

B40. Per the module, when notifying key staff and contacts about a departing employee, employers should generally:

- ☐ **A)** Disclose the full reason for the employee's departure
- ☐ **B)** Avoid disclosing the reason for the employee's departure
- ☐ **C)** Wait until the employee's last day to say anything
- ☐ **D)** Only inform the employee's direct manager

Part III — True/False Exercises (C1–C40)

Mark whether each statement is True or False.

Employee Turnover

C1. Per the module, voluntary turnover occurs when the employee initiates the departure.

☐ True ☐ False

C2. Per the module, all turnover is negative for an organization.

☐ True ☐ False

C3. Per the module, dysfunctional turnover happens when key individuals or high performers leave, often at critical times.

☐ True ☐ False

Employee Retention

C4. Per the module, money is described as the only reason people leave an organization.

☐ True ☐ False

C5. Per the module, training employees only benefits other employers who might hire them away, never the original employer.

☐ True ☐ False

C6. Per the module, organizations should be especially concerned about retention during periods of organizational change.

☐ True ☐ False

Employee Survey

C7. Per the module, job satisfaction is the degree to which employees have a positive affective orientation toward their employment by the organization.

☐ True ☐ False

C8. Per the module, benchmarking is not useful when analyzing employee survey results.

☐ True ☐ False

C9. Per the module, an employee survey only becomes effective once something is done with the results.

☐ True ☐ False

Employee Focus Group

C10. Per the module, employee focus groups typically use employee survey results as a starting point for discussion.

☐ True ☐ False

C11. Per the module, employees who experience follow-up after a survey are, on average, less engaged than those who do not.

☐ True ☐ False

Exit Interviews

C12. Per the module, exit interviews can help minimize an employer's exposure in litigation.

☐ True ☐ False

C13. Per the module, having an employee's own supervisor conduct their exit interview is described as a good idea.

☐ True ☐ False

C14. Per the module, an exit interview should be conducted in a private place before the employee's last day.

☐ True ☐ False

Employee Relations Programs

C15. Per the module, employee recognition is the acknowledgement of an individual or team's behavior, effort, and accomplishments that support organizational goals.

☐ True ☐ False

C16. Per the module, diversity and inclusion programs have no impact on employee retention.

☐ True ☐ False

Grievance Management

C17. Per the module, a formal grievance procedure is described as a valuable communication tool for the organization.

☐ True ☐ False

C18. Per the module, an employer should promise complete confidentiality during a grievance investigation.

☐ True ☐ False

C19. Per the module, the investigator in a grievance case should be someone respected within the organization who can act as a credible witness.

☐ True ☐ False

C20. Per the module, grievance arbitration is described as inexpensive and quick compared to court.

☐ True ☐ False

Alternative Dispute Resolution

C21. Per the module, arbitration results in a binding decision that both employee and employer must accept.

☐ True ☐ False

C22. Per the module, peer review involves only managers, with no employee representatives.

☐ True ☐ False

Workforce Reduction

C23. Per the module, redundancy occurs when a position is declared surplus and redeployment opportunities have been exhausted.

☐ True ☐ False

C24. Per the module, at-will employees have no rights at all during a workforce reduction.

☐ True ☐ False

C25. Per the module, mergers and acquisitions are listed as a reason organizations engage in downsizing.

☐ True ☐ False

Progressive Discipline

C26. Per the module, progressive discipline is intended as punishment rather than as assistance to the employee.

☐ True ☐ False

C27. Per the module, informal verbal warnings are always documented, even though they do not go into the employee's personnel file as a formal notice.

☐ True ☐ False

C28. Per the module, termination is typically the first step in a progressive discipline system.

☐ True ☐ False

Managing Workplace Behaviors

C29. Per the module, non-culpable behavior means the employee is not blameworthy, such as a legitimate absence due to illness.

☐ True ☐ False

C30. Per the module, bullying is considered a "two-way street" where both parties are equally responsible.

☐ True ☐ False

C31. Per the module, sexual harassment involves unwanted verbal, non-verbal, or physical conduct of a sexual nature that violates a person's dignity.

☐ True ☐ False

C32. Per the module, substance abuse issues in the workplace only affect the performance of the employee involved and no one else.

☐ True ☐ False

Termination

C33. Per the module, IT should immediately revoke a terminated employee's computer, network, and data access.

☐ True ☐ False

C34. Per the module, employers should go into detailed reasons for a termination when communicating with remaining staff.

☐ True ☐ False

Outplacement

C35. Per the module, outplacement services are contracted for by the employer to help laid-off employees transition to a new job.

☐ True ☐ False

C36. Per the module, outplacement reduces the threat of litigation for the employer, per the module's listed benefits.

☐ True ☐ False

C37. Per the module, all employees who receive outplacement services as part of severance always use them.

☐ True ☐ False

Employee Offboarding

C38. Per the module, obtaining a resignation letter is one of the recommended offboarding steps.

☐ True ☐ False

C39. Per the module, final pay laws may require including accrued, unused vacation and PTO in an employee's final pay.

☐ True ☐ False

C40. Per the module, a non-solicitation clause restricts an employee's ability to contact present, past, or prospective clients of the employer after employment ends.

☐ True ☐ False

Answer Key

Type A written-response exercises have no single correct wording and are not included below; your facilitator will assess these against the concepts covered in the module.

Multiple Choice Answer Key (B1–B40)

B1 B	B2 A	B3 B	B4 A	B5 A
B6 B	B7 B	B8 B	B9 C	B10 B
B11 A	B12 B	B13 B	B14 B	B15 B
B16 A	B17 B	B18 A	B19 B	B20 A
B21 C	B22 B	B23 B	B24 B	B25 C
B26 B	B27 C	B28 B	B29 B	B30 A
B31 B	B32 B	B33 B	B34 B	B35 B
B36 A	B37 B	B38 D	B39 B	B40 B

True/False Answer Key (C1–C40)

C1 T	C2 F	C3 T	C4 F	C5 F
C6 T	C7 T	C8 F	C9 T	C10 T
C11 F	C12 T	C13 F	C14 T	C15 T
C16 F	C17 T	C18 F	C19 T	C20 F
C21 T	C22 F	C23 T	C24 F	C25 T
C26 F	C27 T	C28 F	C29 T	C30 F
C31 T	C32 F	C33 T	C34 F	C35 T
C36 T	C37 F	C38 T	C39 T	C40 T